

D647

Evaluating a Communications Strategy

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A hospital communications team, which recently moved to a new floor, reports on a flu-shot campaign: 25 news stories, 1.2 million impressions, and a 30% rise in flu shots given compared with last season. Which result is the outcome?

- A. Better teamwork after the move to the new floor.
- B. The 30% rise in flu shots given.
- C. The 25 news stories.
- D. The 1.2 million impressions.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which of these is an output rather than an outcome?

- A. An 8% increase in program sign-ups.
- B. Awareness rose from 20% to 35% in a survey.
- C. 12 press releases distributed.
- D. Donations up \$40,000 over last year.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A PR agency with offices in three cities tells a client that its news coverage “would have cost \$250,000 as ads,” so the campaign earned \$250,000. The client’s goal was more volunteer sign-ups. What is the best evaluation approach?

- A. Report \$250,000 as the campaign’s return.
- B. Count the number of articles instead.
- C. Trust the figure because a multi-city agency produced it.
- D. Drop the ad-value figure and measure the change in volunteer sign-ups.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A software firm's top goal is to reduce customer churn. Its communications team, which just launched a podcast, is choosing KPIs for a customer onboarding campaign. Which KPI aligns best?

- A. Number of press mentions.
- B. Podcast downloads.
- C. Number of onboarding emails sent.
- D. Renewal rate of customers who got the onboarding emails vs. those who didn't.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A blood-drive campaign at a university that just opened a new stadium tracks weekly online appointment bookings and the final number of pints collected. Which is the leading indicator?

- A. Stadium attendance
- B. Both are lagging indicators.
- C. Weekly appointment bookings
- D. Pints collected

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A museum that just renovated its west wing sent an email to 40,000 subscribers. 32,000 were delivered, 8,000 opened, 960 clicked, and 240 bought tickets. What is the click-through rate based on delivered emails?

- A. 3%
- B. 12%
- C. 2.4%
- D. 25%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A campaign targets a 20% conversion rate from clicks to purchases. It expects 1,500 clicks. How many purchases does it need?

- A. 30
- B. 300
- C. 1,200
- D. 7,500

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A city's recycling campaign, run by a communications office with a new director, raised monthly sign-ups from 1,600 to 2,000. The director presented it with a bar chart. What is the percent increase?

- A. 25%
- B. 20%
- C. 400
- D. 125%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Sign-ups must rise 15% from a baseline to reach 2,300. What is the baseline?

- A. 2,000
- B. 345
- C. 2,645
- D. 1,955

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

The communications director at a regional airline that just rolled out new uniforms wants to show the board how website traffic changed month by month over two years. Which chart fits best?

- A. A single bar showing the two-year total
- B. A pie chart
- C. A photo of the new uniforms
- D. A line chart

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A nonprofit with a volunteer-run newsletter tests a fundraising email. Version B changes the subject line, the button color, and the send time. B raises more money. The nonprofit's mascot is an owl. What can it conclude?

- A. Every future email must use all three changes forever.
- B. B performed better, but it can't tell which change caused it.
- C. Adding the owl mascot would raise more.
- D. The subject line caused the lift.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

To learn whether the subject line drives opens, how should the next test be designed?

- A. Change the subject line and send time together again.
- B. Send version B only to the most engaged donors.
- C. Change only the subject line, keep all else the same, and split the list randomly.
- D. Send one version to everyone with no split.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A hospital communications team, ~~which recently moved to a new floor,~~ reports on a flu-shot campaign: 25 news stories, 1.2 million impressions, and a 30% rise in flu shots given compared with last season. Which result is the outcome?

Target word: find the outcome **Decides:** A change in audience behavior.

A	Camouflage	An internal detail, not a campaign outcome.
B	Correct	A behavior change in the audience.
C	Confusion set	Media coverage is an output.
D	Adjacent category	Exposure, not a change in behavior.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

Which of these is an output rather than an outcome?

Target word: find the output **Decides:** Something the team produced.

A	Inverted operation	Behavior change: outcome.
B	Confusion set	A change in audience knowledge.
C	Correct	An activity count.
D	Adjacent category	Behavior change: outcome.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A PR agency ~~with offices in three cities~~ tells a client that its news coverage “would have cost \$250,000 as ads,” so the campaign earned \$250,000. The client’s goal was more volunteer sign-ups. What is the best evaluation approach?

Target word: valid measurement **Decides:** AVE isn’t a valid measure; the goal is sign-ups.

A	Inverted operation	AVE isn’t return; it ignores results.
B	Adjacent category	Still an output, not the goal.
C	Camouflage	Agency size doesn’t validate the method.
D	Correct	Measure the outcome tied to the goal.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A software firm’s top goal is to reduce customer churn. Its communications team, ~~which just launched a podcast,~~ is choosing KPIs for a customer onboarding campaign. Which KPI aligns best?

Target word: aligned KPI **Decides:** The goal is retention.

A	Adjacent category	Visibility, not retention.
B	Camouflage	Not linked to churn.
C	Dropped element	An output, not the result.
D	Correct	Measures retention directly.

5. Answer C Concept 4

A blood-drive campaign at a university ~~that just opened a new stadium~~ tracks weekly online appointment bookings and the final number of pints collected. Which is the leading indicator?

Target word: leading indicator **Decides:** Which moves first and predicts the result.

A	Camouflage	Not a campaign measure.
B	Confusion set	Bookings come before the result.
C	Correct	Bookings come before and predict pints collected.
D	Inverted operation	The final result is lagging.

6. Answer A Concept 5

A museum ~~that just renovated its west wing~~ sent an email to 40,000 subscribers. 32,000 were delivered, 8,000 opened, 960 clicked, and 240 bought tickets. What is the click-through rate based on delivered emails?

Target word: CTR on delivered **Decides:** 960 / 32,000.

A	Correct	$960 / 32,000 = 3\%$.
B	Adjacent category	$960 / 8,000$ is click-to-open rate.
C	Wrong stem number	$960 / 40,000$ uses sent, not delivered.
D	Confusion set	$240 / 960$ is the conversion rate.

7. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A campaign targets a 20% conversion rate from clicks to purchases. It expects 1,500 clicks. How many purchases does it need?

Target word: solve for purchases **Decides:** $20\% \times 1,500$.

A	Wrong stem number	Uses 2% instead of 20%.
B	Correct	$0.20 \times 1,500 = 300$.
C	Confusion set	That is the clicks that don't convert.
D	Inverted operation	Divides by 0.20 instead of multiplying.

8. Answer A Concept 6

A city's recycling campaign, run by a communications office ~~with a new director~~, raised monthly sign-ups from 1,600 to 2,000. ~~The director presented it with a bar chart.~~ What is the percent increase?

Target word: percent change **Decides:** $400 / 1,600$.

A	Correct	$(2,000 - 1,600) / 1,600 = 25\%$.
B	Inverted operation	Divides by the new value.
C	Dropped element	The raw change, not a percentage.
D	Confusion set	That is the new value as a share of the old.

9. Answer A Concept 6 • transfer

Sign-ups must rise 15% from a baseline to reach 2,300. What is the baseline?

Target word: solve for baseline **Decides:** 2,300 / 1.15.

A	Correct	$2,300 / 1.15 = 2,000$.
B	Dropped element	15% of 2,300, not the baseline.
C	Confusion set	Adds 15% to the target.
D	Inverted operation	Takes 15% off 2,300 instead of dividing.

10. Answer D Concept 7

The communications director at a regional airline ~~that just rolled out new uniforms~~ wants to show the board how website traffic changed month by month over two years. Which chart fits best?

Target word: chart choice **Decides:** A trend over time.

A	Dropped element	Hides the month-by-month change.
B	Confusion set	Pies show parts of a whole, not trends.
C	Camouflage	Not data.
D	Correct	Line charts show change over time.

11. Answer B Concept 8

A nonprofit ~~with a volunteer-run newsletter~~ tests a fundraising email. Version B changes the subject line, the button color, and the send time. B raises more money. ~~The nonprofit's mascot is an owl.~~ What can it conclude?

Target word: valid conclusion **Decides:** Three variables changed at once.

A	Absolute language	Overreaches from one test.
B	Correct	Multiple changes confound the result.
C	Camouflage	Not tested.
D	Adjacent category	Can't separate it from the other two changes.

12. Answer C Concept 8 • transfer

To learn whether the subject line drives opens, how should the next test be designed?

Target word: design a clean test **Decides:** Isolate one variable.

A	Inverted operation	Repeats the confounding.
B	Adjacent category	Non-random split biases the result.
C	Correct	Isolates the variable.
D	Dropped element	No comparison group.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	1	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Outputs vs. outcomes	Outputs are what the team produced (releases, posts, impressions); outcomes are changes in audience knowledge, attitude, or behavior.	Reporting activity counts as results.	A list of campaign metrics.
2	No advertising value equivalency	Measurement standards (Barcelona Principles) reject AVE; measure effects tied to goals instead.	Calling ad-equivalent value a return.	"Would have cost \$X as ads."
3	KPIs aligned to goals	A KPI must measure progress on the organization's actual goal.	Choosing easy-to-count vanity metrics.	An organizational goal and several candidate KPIs.
4	Leading vs. lagging indicators	Leading indicators move early and predict results; lagging indicators confirm results after the fact.	Calling the final result a leading indicator.	Early activity vs. final outcome.
5	Funnel rates	CTR = clicks / delivered; click-to-open = clicks / opens; conversion = purchases / clicks. Use the right denominator.	Dividing by the wrong base.	Sent, delivered, opened, clicked, bought.
6	Percent change from a baseline	Percent change = (new – old) / old × 100.	Dividing by the new value.	A before and after figure.
7	Choosing a chart	Line charts show trends over time; bar charts compare categories; pie charts show parts of one whole with few slices.	Using a pie or a single total for a time trend.	"Over time" or "compare."
8	A/B testing	Change one variable at a time and split the audience randomly to learn what caused a difference.	Changing several things and crediting one.	A test where versions differ in more than one way.

Course scope (public description): Evaluating a Communications Strategy introduces students to key performance indicators (KPIs) used to measure the effectiveness of strategic communications plans. Students will develop metrics that align with specific organizational performance goals and will understand how to use these metrics to assess and improve communication strategies. As students gain hands-on experience in measuring and optimizing communications strategies to achieve business objectives, they will select appropriate KPIs for a given strategic communications plan, analyze results, use data visualization to present outcomes, and recommend continuous improvements. In this course, students will collaborate with peers as they gain the skills necessary to determine KPIs and iterate on communications strategies.